Add-on: Scene refresh (rainforest home + fuller game backdrops)

Everything from the original brief is done and pushed to `origin/main`. This is a **design-only pass on the four ambient scenes.**

- **Don't change:** game logic, the API, the boards, the side panel, or the layout rules in `CLAUDE.md`.
- **Work in:** `frontend/src/themes/**`, plus `pages/Home.*` only if the thumbnails need it.

Attached: a new moodboard for the home page, a Pinterest rainforest board. If you can't see the attachment, it's at `C:\Users\ustec\Downloads\Chess_Project\jungle-rainforest.png`.

- Use it for mood and palette only. **Don't commit it.** The repo is public and the image isn't ours.
- The other three moodboards still apply: ocean, winter and desert.

How to work

1. **Look first.** Open `docs/screenshots/` and read the four `*Scene.tsx` files before changing anything.
2. **Build, then report back.** You don't need my approval for each item.
    - If something I suggested looks bad once it's drawn, cut it or swap it, and tell me why in your final report. I'd rather lose an item than keep a bad one.
    - Put anything you're unsure about in its own commit so it's easy to remove.
3. **Commit, test, push.**
    - Commit once per scene.
    - Run every test.
    - Refresh the screenshots.
    - Push to `origin main`.

1. Style rules for everything you add: simple and cute, not AI slop

- **Match the current flat look.**
    - Use flat SVG shapes and soft rounded forms.
    - Give each object 2–4 tones taken from (or mixed from) its scene palette.
    - Don't add outlines, textures, new gradients, glows or drop shadows. The one exception is a flat, soft ground-shadow ellipse under objects.

- **Cute means simple.**
  - Draw rounded, slightly chunky shapes with tiny dark dot eyes (one optional 1 px highlight).
  - Don't draw mouths, teeth, eyelashes, expressions, clothing or animals standing on two legs.
  - Nothing should resemble a known character, so no Nemo or Dory fish and no Disney or Pokémon lookalikes.
- **Keep things small and tucked in.**
  - Hero animals should be about 6–12% of the viewport height.
  - Tuck them partly behind leaves, rocks, kelp or snowbanks, so they feel discovered rather than placed.
  - Far objects are lighter and hazier (atmospheric perspective), like the existing layers.
- **Fuller, not busy.**
  - On a game page, add at most about 5 new elements.
  - Small pops of colour from animals or flowers should cover no more than about 5% of the picture.
  - When in doubt, cut.
- **No text, signs or logos in any scene.**
- **The board stays the hero.** On game pages no prop may be brighter, more saturated or higher-contrast than the board and its pieces.
  - The scrim currently desaturates the whole scene to `saturate(0.55)`. If that makes the props muddy, give props their own layer in `SceneFrame` with a lighter filter (around 0.75–0.85). Check that the board still wins.

2. Where props go: visible zones only

On game pages, the board and the side panel (≥1100 px) cover most of the scene, so a prop behind them is wasted.

- **Placement zones:** put hero props in the zones that stay visible:
  - the left gutter
  - the bottom strip
  - the gap between the board and the panel
  - the band under the top bar
- **Positioning:** use viewport-relative positions with `clamp()` sizes.
- **Backgammon:** its gutters are the narrowest (about 100 px at 1440×900). Favour tall, narrow props on the left edge and small props along the bottom.
- **Mobile:** below 600 px wide, hide the crossers and the secondary props, and keep one hero prop per scene.
- **Tagging and testing:** mark each hero prop `data-prop="hero"`. Add a Playwright check that every hero prop is at least 50% visible, not covered by the board or the panel, at 1440×900 and 1920×1080.

3. Home: rebuild the jungle as a rainforest

What's wrong now: the page reads like "a haunted, deserted mountain town" because of three things.

- **Mountains:** the open sky and far ridges look like mountains.
- **Gloom:** the grey, desaturated haze and near-black foreground silhouettes feel gloomy.
- **Poles:** the bamboo stalks look like fence posts or telephone poles.

Rebuild it as a lush, enclosed rainforest, like the new moodboard.

- **No mountains or open sky.** The top is a canopy with small gaps of light.

- **New palette** (a starting point; check AA contrast for the title and subtitle):

Role	**Colour**
Canopy shade	`#0E2E1C`
Emerald	`#1B5A34`
Leaf	`#2F7D3E`
Fresh leaf	`#6FAE45`
Sunlit lime	`#A9CF5E`
Moss	`#6B8E3A`
Trunk	`#4A3B2C` / `#2F271E`
Mist	`#D6E8CF`
Warm light	`#F4EFC4`
Water	`#A7D8CC`
Heliconia red (tiny amounts)	`#C8323C`
Toucan orange	the existing `#E8742C`

- **Layers, back to front:**

1. Canopy band across the top: layered leaf masses in dark-to-mid greens, with a few bright gaps.
2. Far forest: tall, misty trunks fading into pale green haze. This is depth, not ridges.
3. Light shafts: keep the existing ones, recoloured warm golden-green at 10–18% opacity.
4. Waterfall: a slim, 2–3 tier waterfall on one side of the mid-ground, falling into a small pool or stream at the bottom.
    - The water flows using a moving dash pattern on transforms, not a filter.
    - Soft mist sits at its base.
5. Mid trunks: 3–5 bigger trunks with buttress roots and moss patches.
    - Lianas or vines hang from the canopy and sway gently.
6. Foreground frame: ferns, monstera, fan palms and a heliconia or two.
    - Use two-tone greens (a light side and a shade side) in place of black silhouettes.
    - Keep the current sway.
7. Optional: a small wooden boardwalk or rope bridge in the mid-distance, as on the moodboard.

- **Keep:** the mist bands and the rare falling leaves, recoloured to match.

- **Animals:** up to 5, around the edges and corners. Keep them clear of the cards and the title.

    - **Toucan or green parrot**
        - Sits on a branch.
        - Tilts its head and blinks every 8–12 s.
        - About once a minute, a parrot flies across the canopy band in a short 4–6 s flight with simple wing flaps.
    - **Monkey**
        - Hangs by its tail from a vine.
        - Slow pendulum swing (±4° over 5–6 s).
        - Looks around now and then.
    - **Sloth**
        - Hangs from a low branch.
        - Nearly still: a slow blink every ~10 s and a very slow head turn every ~30 s.
    - **Snake (green tree python)**
        - Draped over a branch near a lower corner.
        - Slow "breathing" ripple along its body.
        - A quick tongue flick every ~12 s.
    - **Optional extras:** 2–3 blue morpho butterflies on lazy paths near the water, or a small frog on a leaf by the pool whose throat puffs now and then.

    - **No panda.** Pandas live in cool mountain bamboo forests, not rainforests. Mixing them in makes the scene feel random. I can add one on a bamboo cluster later if I want it.

4. Connect Four: ocean

- **Seabed:** a lighter sandy floor along the bottom, muted by depth, with a few shells and a starfish in front of the existing reef rocks.
- **Treasure chest** (hero, bottom-left)
    - Half-buried in sand with its lid slightly open.
    - The gold rim glints softly (an opacity pulse every ~6 s).
    - A few bubbles escape from the lid every 8–10 s.
- **Seahorse** (hero, by the left kelp)
    - Its tail is curled around a kelp stem.
    - It bobs ±6 px over about 4 s, with a quick fin flutter.
- **Fish school:** 5–7 small fish in a loose formation cross the mid-water every 25–35 s on a gentle sine path. They enter and leave through the visible margins.
- **Reef fish:** 1–2 near the reef swim lazily back and forth with soft turnarounds. Use generic yellow, teal and coral colours, not clownfish stripes.
- **Coral and anemone:** a couple of simple branching corals in muted coral pink, plus an anemone whose tentacles sway.
- **Optional:** one translucent jellyfish drifting slowly upward with a gentle bell pulse.
- **Keep** the manta, light rays and bubbles.

5. Checkers: winter

- **Snow on the trees** (required)
    - Every pine tier, near and far, gets a white snow cap along its top edge, with a slight blue shadow underneath.
    - Add one or two bigger, heavily snowed pines in the left gutter.
    - Every 20–30 s, a little clump of snow slides off a branch with a soft puff.
- **Frozen lake**
    - A pale ice-blue lake in the mid-ground, visible from the left gutter or the bottom strip.
    - It faintly reflects the trees, has a few hairline cracks, and a slow light glint sweeps across it every ~12 s.
- **Arctic fox** (hero)
    - White with soft blue-grey shading, sitting curled on a snowbank by the lake.
    - Every 6–8 s its tail swishes or an ear twitches, and it blinks slowly.
    - About once a minute it looks up at the falling snow.
    - A line of small paw prints leads to it.
- **Optional:**
    - A small, far-off grey wolf on a ridge that lifts its head now and then.

    - A small log cabin among the far pines with one warm window (`#F2C48D`, a very subtle flicker) and a thin chimney-smoke curl.
- **Keep** the snowfall and the faint aurora.
- **No penguins or polar bears.** It's the wrong biome.

6. Backgammon: desert (American Southwest)

Keep the biome consistent: saguaros, mesas, skulls and tumbleweed. No pyramids or camels.

- **Saguaro cacti**
    - One tall saguaro with raised arms in the left-gutter foreground (hero).
    - One or two smaller, hazier ones on the far dunes.
- **Prickly pear:** a cluster near the bottom with one small pink flower.
- **Cow skull** (hero)
    - Bleached and half-sunk in the sand near the big saguaro.
    - Static.
- **Tumbleweed**
    - Rolls along the bottom strip every 25–40 s, spinning, with small bounces, and leaves off-screen.
    - Trigger it with the existing sand gust, so the wind and the tumbleweed feel connected.
- **Mesa:** a distant mesa or butte silhouette on the horizon, hazy and static (the Monument Valley look from the moodboard).
- **Optional:**
    - A small lizard on a rock that does a quick head-bob every ~15 s.
    - A small hawk drifting in a slow, wide circle high in the sky.

7. Home card thumbnails

The cards render each scene with `mode="thumbnail"`, so the new props carry over. Make sure each portrait crop clearly shows its signature props:

Card	**Signature props**
Ocean	Seahorse + treasure chest
Winter	Snowy pines + fox by the lake
Desert	Saguaro + skull (the tumbleweed rolls through on hover)

- If needed, reposition props for thumbnails with `[data-mode='thumbnail']` CSS.
- Keep the props clear of the piece emblem at the bottom centre of each card.

- Props animate only while the card is hovered, which is the existing behaviour.

8. Motion rules

- **How to animate:**
  - Use CSS keyframes on `transform` and `opacity` only, with `transform-box: fill-box` and a per-part `transform-origin`.
  - The existing particle canvas is fine to reuse.
  - No new canvases, no per-prop JavaScript animation loops, and no animated SVG filters.
- **Mostly idle:**
  - Each animal is at rest most of the time, and its action takes no more than about 15% of its loop.
  - Use loop lengths that don't line up (e.g. 7.3 s, 11.7 s, 13.9 s) so animations never sync.
- **Crossers are rare:** the fish school, parrot flight and tumbleweed run once every 25–60 s, one at a time per scene.
- **Soft easing:** no cartoon squash-and-stretch, except a tiny tumbleweed bounce.
- **Pausing:**
  - The existing rule `.scene:not([data-animate='true']) * { animation-play-state: paused }` must still freeze everything for reduced motion, the Ambient toggle and non-hovered thumbnails.
  - The paused frame must look natural: animals in their rest pose and crossers off-screen.
- **Performance:** with motion on, keep about 60 fps at 1920×1080 and don't add noticeable CPU.

9. Verify before pushing

1. All backend, Vitest and Playwright tests pass, including the layout test and the new hero-visibility check.
2. Refresh the screenshots: `SCREENSHOTS=1 npx playwright test screenshots`. Also capture the home page at 1440×900 with each card hovered.
3. **Open every screenshot and check:**
   - Does the home page read instantly as a bright, lush rainforest, and not mountains or gloom?
   - Is each hero prop visible at 1280×720, 1440×900 and 1920×1080?
   - Is anything muddy, cluttered, too bright, or crowding the title, cards or board?
   - Fix it and re-shoot until the answer is clean.

10. Docs, commit, push

- **`docs/DECISIONS.md`:** add a short "Scene refresh" note: what was added, anything cut or swapped and why, and the biome-consistency choice.
- **`docs/TIME_LOG.md`:** add a row for this pass.
- **`CLAUDE.md`:** add 2–3 lines on the prop style rules (Section 1) and the motion rules (Section 8).
- **Commits**, one per scene:
    - "Rebuild home scene as a rainforest with animals"
    - "Add sea life and a treasure chest to the ocean scene"
    - "Add a frozen lake, arctic fox and snow-laden pines to the winter scene"
    - "Add cacti, skull and tumbleweed to the desert scene"
    - "Refresh screenshots"
- **Push:** `git push origin main`.

11. Report back to me

- **Per scene:** what you added and which animations, with screenshot paths.
- **Cut or swapped:** anything you cut or swapped and why, plus anything you think looks off and want my call on.
- **Confirmation:** that the tests passed and the push succeeded, with the final commit hash.